



HUMANITAS
INSTITUTE

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: New Life Community Church School

School Website: <https://newlifecr.com/>

January 7, 2026

Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

ACCS STARTUP

Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools (ACCS) is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because ACCS require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Overall Classification: **CLASSICAL**

Executive Summary

New Life Community Church School (Marion, IA, 52302) presents a distinctly Christian community identity rooted in church life and homeschooling-oriented activities. Public materials show a strong theological orientation (gospel-centric language, pastors, ministry, and family-formation programs) and concrete parental engagement (e.g., parenting seminars and home-school events). However, direct, explicit evidence of core classical elements (e.g., liberal arts curriculum, Great Books, Socratic pedagogy, memory work, and the "living curriculum" faculty model) is not observed in the public materials available through the crawl. On balance, the school demonstrates a Christian formation emphasis with some parental involvement in educational matters, but falls short on explicit classical curriculum and pedagogy signals. The overall assessment is **SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL**, with clear movement opportunities toward **CLASSICAL** if specific classical elements are foregrounded in site content (see "What would move the needle" below).

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

- **Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL** Evidence: Explicit Christian/theological framing is evident (gospel language, pastors, ministry). The site content references gospel-centered formation and church-based activities (e.g., "Thank you for partnering in the gospel of Jesus Christ" and Titus 2 ministry context). Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive indicators draw on theology-focused language (Theology, biblical worldview, gospel). Negative indicators: none observed. Why this rating: Strong theological grounding aligns with the "Grounded in Theology" and "Liturgical/Communal" tendencies in classical lexicons; the explicit church/religious framing supports transcendent moral aims.
- **Element 2: Purpose and Goal — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL** Evidence: The institution centers on religious formation for families and students (home-school seminars, Titus 2 ministry, parenting seminars). While formation and virtue-oriented aims are implied through church-based formation, explicit statements about virtue/wisdom formation or the true/good/beautiful telos in an educational sense are not clearly stated. Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive indicators include terms around formation and moral aims in a Christian frame (though not universal across the classical keywords list). Negative indicators: absence of explicit classical telos language (e.g., "true, good, beautiful" as educational telos, or "paideia" in the school's own phrasing). Based on the keyword framework, the presence of formation-oriented church activity meets some classical expectations but lacks full Great-Conversation/true telos articulation. Why this rating: The school emphasizes formation within a Christian framework, but does not consistently articulate the classical telos and humanistic aims (truth, goodness, beauty as real objectives) in explicit educational terms.
- **Element 3: Curriculum — NOT CLASSICAL** Evidence: Public materials show homeschooling events, parenting programs, and church-sponsored activities; there is no explicit mention of liberal arts (grammar/logic/rhetoric), Great Books, Great Conversation, or formal engagement with history as a univer-

sal discipline across the curriculum. The content is predominantly church/ministry oriented rather than classical curriculum components. Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive indicators of classical curriculum (grammar, logic, rhetoric, Great Books, history-as-civilization) are not present. Negative signals in the classical lexicon emphasize absence of liberal arts, Great Books, or memory-based pedagogy; these do not appear. Overall: few or no classical curriculum keywords observed. Why this rating: The absence of explicit liberal arts/core classical curriculum terms and arrangements places the category in NOT CLASSICAL.

- Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — NOT CLASSICAL Evidence: No explicit mention of Socratic seminars, memory work, chanting, recitation, or upper- or lower-school rhetoric training on the site. The visible material is church/community-centered (seminars, sermons, and ministry events) rather than a classical pedagogy. Positive/Negative keyword analysis: The classical pedagogy indicators (Socratic dialogue, memory work, scholé-oriented rest, rhetoric training) are not evidenced; thus no positive classical pedagogy signals are observed. Absence signals: not described as “Socratic,” “drill/recitation,” or “rhetoric-focused” pedagogy in the site content. Why this rating: Without explicit classical teaching methods, the category aligns with NOT CLASSICAL.
- Element 5: Faculty — NOT CLASSICAL Evidence: The site mentions pastors/ministry leaders and congregational leadership, but there is no described living-curriculum faculty model, teacher portraits, or collegial “faculty of friends” dynamics as the core of the school’s educational approach. Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive classical faculty indicators (living curriculum, faculty of friends, portrait of teacher/students) are not evidenced in the public materials. The available content emphasizes church leadership rather than a formal classroom faculty structure. Why this rating: Absence of the classical “faculty as living curriculum” signals suggests NOT CLASSICAL in this category.
- Element 6: Parents & Community — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL Evidence: There is active parental/community engagement through parenting seminars, a home-school seminar, and family-oriented church activities (Titus 2 Ministry). This demonstrates parent involvement and a community framework, albeit within a church/ministry context rather than a formal classical-education partnership model. Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive indicators include parental formation, family involvement, and open-to-visits/community engagement. The classical keyword framework expects explicit “parents as co-teachers” and robust parent-education programs; while somewhat present (Parenting Seminar, Home School events), the language doesn’t fully commit to the classical co-teaching partnership. Negative indicators: absence of explicit “parents as co-teachers” language in the site content. Why this rating: The school shows substantive parent/community engagement within a faith-based setting, but it does not fully embody the classical model of parents as co-teachers or formal parental education programs in classical terms.

Overall Classification and Aggregate Assessment

- Aggregate Ranking: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Rationale: The New Life Community Church School (Marion, IA, 52302) demonstrates a clear religious/theological orientation and offers family-centered homeschooling events, which align with some classical aims (formation, virtue, community) within a Christian framework. However, it lacks explicit classical curriculum elements (Great Books, liberal arts sequence), classical pedagogy signals (Socratic method, scholé, memory work), and the traditional living-curriculum faculty model. The strongest evidence sits in Element 1 (Religious and Metaphysical Foundations) and Element 6 (Parents & Community), with Element 2 showing partial alignment. The absence of explicit signals in Categories 3–5 places the overall ranking in SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL, rather than CLASSICAL or NOT CLASSICAL.

What Would Move the Needle

- Explicit articulation of a classical curriculum in site content, including:
- Clear statements about liberal arts (grammar, logic, rhetoric) and a plan for Great Books or classical primary sources.
- History taught throughout the curriculum as a core discipline, not as “social studies.”
- Expressions of Great Conversation and telos oriented toward truth, goodness, and beauty.

- Publicly described pedagogy that includes Socratic seminars, memory work, and rhetoric training (and age-appropriate deployment for K–12).
- A clearly defined “living curriculum” concept, with a visible portrait or description of the faculty as mentors and colleagues who model virtue and knowledge, and a culture of faculty collaboration.
- A formal parent-teacher partnership model where parents are recognized as co-teachers and are offered structured formation opportunities (reading groups, book studies, and classical-education trainings) beyond occasional seminars.
- Evidence of a liturgical or liturgical-inspired communal rhythm (regular chapel/mass/prayer practices, liturgical calendar integration) alongside academic instruction.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

By reading or using this document, you acknowledge and accept the limitations described above.